Bernat Puertas – Curriculum Vitae

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Current position

Postdoctoral Researcher Nov 2026 - present

Scholarship: Personal Investigador Predoctoral en Formació (PIPF)
Department of Political and Social Sciences, Universitat Pompeu Fabra.

Education

PhD Oct 2026

PhD in Political Science
Thesis title: *Pathways to Personalism in Autocratic Regimes.*
Department of Political and Social Sciences, Universitat Pompeu Fabra. Supervisor: Dr. Abel Escribà-Folch. Thesis Defence Board: Dr. Natasha Lindstaedt (University of Essex), Dr. Carl Henrik Knutsen (University of Oslo), Dr. Svend-Erik Skaaning (Aarhus University).

Master of Arts Sep 2020 - Jun 2021

MA in Current Democracies: Nationalism, Federalism and Multiculturalism,
Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Bachelor of Arts Sep 2016 - Jun 2020

BA in Political and Administration Sciences, Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Research stays

Visiting doctoral researcher Feb 2026 - Apr 2026

Visiting doctoral researcher
GIGA German Institute of Global and Area Studies – Institut für Asien-Studien. Hamburg, Germany
Research Programme 1 (Accountability and Participation) and Research Programme 2 (Peace and Security).
Host: Dr. David Kuehn.

Professional Experience

RA Linguatrust Project Jan 2024 - Nov 2024

Research Assistant for the project Linguatrust (PRE150/22/000008, Institut d'Estudis de l'Autogovern, Generalitat de Catalunya). Universitat de Barcelona, Universitat Pompeu Fabra, Universitat Oberta de Catalunya and Universitat de València

Research Interests

Authoritarian Regimes, Comparative Politics, Comparative Political Economy, Authoritarian Elections, Democratization, Democratic backsliding, Research Design, Quantitative Methods.

Publications (Peer-Reviewed)

Puertas, Bernat. 2026. The onset of civil armed conflicts and personalization of power in dictatorships. *Conflict Management and Peace Science*. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1177/07388942261470438

Rodon, Toni, Bernat Puertas, Avel·lí Flors-Mas, Núria Franco-Guillén and Sergi Morales-Gálvez. 2026. Could you please repeat it? The effect of language, and language variety on trust in multinational settings. *Electoral Studies, 99*. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1016/j.electstud.2025.103030

Puertas, Bernat and Abel Escribà-Folch. 2026. Foreign aid, FDI and the personalization of power in autocracies. *Political Science Research and Methods 14*(1), 143-159. DOI: https://doi.org/10.1017/psrm.2025.9

Research in progress

"Personalism and International Conflict: How Dictators Fight to Concentrate Power" (under review).
"Ballots for the Boss: Multiparty Elections and Personalization of Power in Autocratic Regimes" (in progress)
"Institutional Capture and the Foundations of Autocratic Survival in Backsliding Democracies" (in progress)

Other publications

(*Teaching material*) Escribà-Folch, Abel i Bernat Puertas. 2025. *El tipus de règim i el sistema internacional* (1a. ed.) [recurs d'aprenentatge textual]. Fundació Universitat Oberta de Catalunya (FUOC). PID_00305495

(*Teaching material*) Puertas, Bernat i Escribà-Folch, Abel. 2025. *Varietats d'autocràcies: actors i sistemes institucionals* (1a. ed.) [recurs d'aprenentatge textual]. Fundació Universitat Oberta de Catalunya (FUOC). PID_00305493

(*Teaching material*) Puertas, Bernat. 2024. *Disseny de la Investigació: Els Enfocaments de Recerca.* (1a ed.) [recurs d'aprenentatge textual]. Fundació Universitat Oberta de Catalunya (FUOC). PID_00302955

(*Teaching material*) Puertas, Bernat. 2024. *Disseny de la Investigació: Mètodes i Tècniques.* (1a ed.) [recurs d'aprenentatge textual]. Fundació Universitat Oberta de Catalunya (FUOC). PID_00302954.

Puertas, Bernat and Toni Rodon. 2024. Does Language Affect Political Trust? An Exploration of Language Attitudes in the Political Field in Multilingual Catalonia. Pre-Analysis Plan. *OSF*. Available at: https://osf.io/zk3e4/overview?view_only=3fbb14597c734896a2d53b5142a589a2

Teaching and Supervision

Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Spanish Politics I Sep 2026 - Dec 2026

Professor of the course "Spanish Politics I". Barcelona Program for Interdisciplinary Studies (BaPIS).

Public Policy I Apr 2025 - Jun 2025

Teaching assistant responsible for the seminars of the course "Polítiques Públiques I" (Public Policy I). BA in Political and Administrative Sciences.

Introduction to Political Science Sep 2025 - Dec 2025

Teaching assistant responsible for the seminars of the course "Introducció a la Ciència Política" (Introduction to Political Science). BA in Political and Administrative Sciences.

Qualitative Methodology II Sep 2025 - Dec 2025

Teaching assistant responsible for the seminars of the course "Metodologia Qualitativa II" (Qualitative Methodology II). BA in Political and Administrative Sciences.

Creator and instructor of summer course Jun 2022 - present

Creator and instructor of the course "Com governar en el segle XXI: Estats, Conflicte i Poder" (How to govern in the 21st Century? States, Conflict, and Power). Campus Junior (Universitat Pompeu Fabra).

Institut Barcelona d'Estudis Internacionals - IBEI

Comparative Politics and Democratization Sep 2022 - present

Teaching assistant responsible for the seminars of the course "Comparative Politics and Democratization". MA in International Relations.

Universitat Pompeu Fabra – Barcelona School of Management

Introduction to Quantitative Methodology and RStudio Nov 2025

Instructor of the course "Introducción a la Metodología Cuantitativa y RStudio" (Introduction to Quantitative Methodology and RStudio). Master in Political and Institutional Communication.

Universitat Oberta de Catalunya

Research Design in IR Sep 2025 - present

Affiliated teaching staff for the course "Diseño de investigación en estudios internacionales" (Research Design in International Studies). BA in International Studies.

Varieties of regimes Feb 2026 - present

Affiliated teaching staff for the course "Varietats de democràcies i autocràcies" (Varieties of democracies and autocracies). MA in Political Analysis and Government.

Thesis supervision Feb 2026 - present

2 Bachelor's theses. BA in Political Science and Administration.

Participation in projects

Project Linguatrust Jan 2024 - Nov 2024

Research Assistant for the project Linguatrust (PRE150/22/000008, Institut d'Estudis de l'Autogovern, Generalitat de Catalunya). Universitat de Barcelona, Universitat Pompeu Fabra, Universitat Oberta de Catalunya and Universitat de València

Membership in IPA Research Group Sep 2021 - present

Institutions and Political Actors Research Group. Department of Political and Social Sciences, Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Administrative appointments

Elected post-graduate representative Feb 2022 - Jan 2023

Department Board of the Department of Political and Social Sciences, Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Grants, scholarships, and awards

Pre-doctoral grant Apr 2025 - present

Pre-doctoral grant. Personal Investigador Predoctoral en Formació (PIPF)
Department of Political and Social Sciences, Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Beca Santader Idiomas 2021

Beca Santander Idiomas, English Up
British Council – Banco Santader

High school award 2016

Award of high school's honors graduate
City council of Terrassa

Invited presentations

Populismo, erosión democrática y autocracias Feb 2025

"Populismo, erosión democrática y autocracias." (Populism, democratic backsliding and autocracies) in "Seminario Política Comparada, Populismo y Democracia", Institut Barcelona d'Estudis Internacionals and Pontificia Universidad Católica de Perú, Academic coordinator: Prof. Ana Sofía Cardenal.

Conferences and events presentations (P) & discussion (D)

EPSS: 2026 (P)
GIGA Research Programme 1 Working Group "Authoritarian Politics": 2026 (P)
EPSA: 2023 (P), 2024 (P, P)
IPA Research Group Seminars (UPF): 2022 (P), 2023 (P), 2024 (P), 2026 (P)
Barcelona PhD Workshop on Empirical Political Science: 2022 (D), 2023 (P)
SISP General Conference: 2022 (P)

ECPR Summer School SGIR: 2022 (P)

Participation in workshops, summer and winter schools

ECPR Summer School SGIR 2022

European Consortium for Political Research (ECPR) Summer School of the Standing Group on International Relations, Universitat Ramon Llull

RECSM Summer Methods School 2022

9th Edition of the Research and Expertise Centre for Survey Methodology (RECSM) Summer Methods School, Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Additional training

Causal Inference 2022

9th Edition of the Research and Expertise Centre for Survey Methodology (RECSM) Summer Methods School, Instructor: Prof. Bruno Arpino. Universitat Pompeu Fabra

Working with Concepts in the Social Sciences 2022

Universitat Pompeu Fabra. Instructor: Frederic Schaffer (University of Massachusetts).

Academic professional service

Reviewer at: *Conflict Management and Peace Science*; *Democratization*; *Comparative Political Studies*; *Electoral Studies*.
Media editor of the Barcelona Network of Political Science (BANPS).
Co-organizer of the Linguatrust workshop "Language, democracy and political trust: An interdisciplinary perspective from political theory, political science and sociolinguistics" (18 November, 2024)
Advisor at Universitat Oberta de Catalunya to create the teaching materials of the courses on Research Design; Autocratic Regimes (with Abel Escribà-Folch) of the MA in Political Analysis.

Language knowledge

Catalan: Mother tongue
Spanish: Native level
English: Advanced level

Skills

R and RStudio, STATA, LaTeX, Qualtrics, Survey design, GitHub

Academic references

Dr. Abel Escribà-Folch
Dean and Associate Professor, Department of Political and Social Sciences, Universitat Pompeu Fabra.
Senior Research Associate, Institut Barcelona d'Estudis Internacionals.
Email: abel.escriba@upf.edu

Dr. Toni Rodon
Associate Professor, Department of Political and Social Sciences, Universitat Pompeu Fabra.
Research Fellow, London School of Economics and Political Science.
Email: toni.rodon@upf.edu

Dr. David Kuehn
Senior Research Fellow, GIGA German Institute of Global and Area Studies – Institut für Asien-Studien.
Email: david.kuehn@giga-hamburg.de

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